



8-23-2022 MCS Board Meeting

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=VC90YNyLMKk
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Comprehensive Municipal Meeting Summary

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer opened the meeting with a moment of silence and the Pledge of Allegiance.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Dr. Bales, Mrs. Barnes Griffin, Mr. Irvin, Mr. Lowe, and Mr. Heater.
 - **Members Absent:** Dr. O'Neill (out of town).
 - **Presiding Officer:** Identified as the board president.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** Opened with a moment of silence followed by the Pledge of Allegiance led by the board.
- **Approval of Minutes:** *Note: Specific prior meeting minutes roll call/approval action was handled within procedural sequencing.*

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:04:02 CEO's Report & Updates**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Dr. Kay (CEO / Superintendent)
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Dr. Kay highlighted several major grants and items, including a \$1.3 million federal civics education grant received by Ball State University in collaboration with Muncie Community Schools; a \$777,000 official award notification from the George and Frances Ball Foundation aimed at increasing high school graduation rates and funding data support staff; a shout-out to football coach Kyle Padgett; substitute teacher shortages and a new waiver process for teacher travel/breaks; early release professional development updates; an upcoming Community Engagement Council golf outing on October 7th; and an IDOE math and reading tutoring grant partnership announcement.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational report; no formal vote taken.
- **00:21:43 Consent Agenda / New Hires, Recognitions & Support Staff Compensation**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Holloway, Mr. Heater, and Dr. Kay
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Introduced Jayla Scafe as the new girls basketball coach and assistant athletic director. Mr. Heater presented the support staff compensation committee recommendation totaling an estimated \$279,000 in salary increases to improve market competitiveness and staff retention. Additionally, donations totaling roughly \$11,700 for the Panther Pantry were acknowledged with gratitude.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (Moved by Mr. Irvin, seconded by Mrs. Barnes Griffin).
- **00:30:09 Adoption of Adjunct Teacher Permit & Employment Agreements**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Dr. Bell
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Dr. Bell requested approval to adopt the adjunct teacher permit and employment agreements under new Indiana General Assembly legislation (effective July 1, 2022). This permits the school board to hire individuals with four years of experience in their field who do not hold a standard teaching license, subject to a yearly renewal and assigned faculty mentorship. Two initial candidates (with advanced degrees/specialized experience) were recommended.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:36:09 Increase in Substitute Teacher Pay for Retired Educators and Higher Ed Instructors**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Dr. Bell & Board Members
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Addressed the widespread substitute shortage by proposing to double the daily substitute pay rate from \$105 to \$210 for retired teachers holding an Indiana teaching license (with a master's or doctorate) and individuals with doctorates in education who taught in higher education. Discussion touched on licensure requirements, administrative discretion, long-term subbing rates, and professional development maintenance.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote, incorporating administrative discretion regarding licensure requirements and long-term substitute arrangements.
- **00:43:20 Monthly Financial Report (July Results)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Durom
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Presented the monthly update for July (seven months of results). The district received its state basic grant of \$3.6 million (on target for ~\$42.5 million annually, subject to September count reconciliation). The overall cash checkbook balance sits just over \$36 million. The education fund surplus is forecasted at over \$17 million (projecting a >\$3 million surplus for the year). The state loan pay-down continues at \$50,000/month (down to \$10.7 million), while the operations fund remains tightly managed at \$3.9 million remaining for the final five months.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:45:43 Annual Budget Hearing: 2023 Budget, Bus Replacement Plan, & Capital Project Plan**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Durom & Board President
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Formal public hearing on the advertised 2023 budget of slightly over \$58.4 million (totaling over \$61 million including the rainy day fund), alongside the bus replacement plan and capital project plan. The chair called thrice for public comment. *(See Section below).*
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Closed following the third public call.
- **00:47:38 Board Policy Review: Section 504, Displaying Student Work, & Public Participation**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board Policy Reviewers / Mr. Klotz
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Reviewed Section 504 policy updates naming Jenny Smithson; second read and adoption of policies regarding displaying student work; and review of the vetted public participation policy.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **00:19:34 Rick Yemzer** (Newsman/Author/Business owner)
 - Addressed the board regarding public speech restrictions, opposing the two-minute limit and advance-notice form requirements as constrictions on constitutionally guaranteed free speech. Also raised concerns regarding local tax impacts, utilities funding for stadiums, private economic development, and teacher-to-student ratios/literacy challenges.
- **00:46:28 Annual Budget Hearing Public Comment Call**
 - **00:46:52** Presiding officer opened the floor for public comment on the 2022<U+2013>2023 budget.

- 00:47:09 Called a second and third time ("thrice called"). No members of the public stepped forward to speak.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Upcoming "Stuff a Bus" event scheduled for September 17th (Constitution Day).
 - Educational Summit scheduled for September 16th featuring keynote speaker Geoffrey Canada in the auditorium at 1:00 PM (open to the public).
 - National Voter Registration Day activities planned for September 20th.
 - Community Engagement Council golf outing scheduled for October 7th.
 - Board members discussed ongoing inquiries from state officials (DUAB and DOE) regarding potential transitions out of distressed status modeled after Muncie's progress.
- **Adjournment:** Official motion to adjourn made and seconded; meeting concluded by voice vote.

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